

ARE YOUR HAND CLEAN?

Psalm 2:3-4; James 4:8

Clean hands save lives! Was the title of an article I found on the internet? There were over 800 sites I could have gone to in order to read about the importance of clean hands. Not one referred me to the Bible though that I saw as I scanned through the list. The clean hands save lives article stated that keeping hands clean is one of the most important steps we can take to avoid getting sick and spreading germs to others. It even told you how to wash your hands.

When washing hands with soap and water:

- Wet your hands with clean running water and apply soap. Use warm water if it is available.
- Rub hands together to make a lather and scrub all surfaces.
- Continue rubbing hands for 20 seconds. Need a timer? Imagine singing "Happy Birthday" twice through to a friend!
- Rinse hands well under running water
- Dry your hands using a paper towel or air dryer. If possible, use your paper towel to turn off the faucet.
- One researcher reported that only about 15% of people in public restrooms wash their hands properly.

When should you wash your hands?

- Before preparing or eating food
- After going to the bathroom
- After changing diapers or cleaning up a child who has gone to the bathroom
- Before and after tending to someone who is sick
- After blowing your nose, coughing, or sneezing
- After handling an animal or animal waste
- After handling garbage
- Before and after treating a cut or wound.

"Who may ascend the hill of the Lord? Who may stand in his holy place? He who has clean hands and a pure heart, who does not lift up his soul to an idol or swear by what is false." Psalm 24 3-4 NIV

Who will go to heaven? Who will have Holy Communion with God? It is a wonderful place to be where God meets his people. People that meet with God in that holy place must keep themselves from all the gross acts of sin. They have clean hands. Hands lifted up in prayer must be pure hands; no blot of unjust gain cleaving to them, nor anything else that defiles the man and is offensive to the holy God.

Hands speak of possession, or keeping: The books should be in her hands by noon.
Power or jurisdiction, "you're in good hands."
Doing or involvement, "Put your hand to the plow and don't look back."

An influence or effect, “Your professor’s hand was in your decision.”
A business agreement often is sealed by a handshake.

Ever heard these expressions
Be careful not to bite the hand that feeds you.
They are living hand to mouth.
They are making money hand over fist. Hands off. Hands up.
She had a hand in that. Those kids are a hand full.
They got out of hand. He had a heavy hand.

He who comes to God must have clean hands. If we don’t have clean hands seeking God will be in vain. Germs on your hands parallel to sin in our heart. Remember what Pilate did before he handed Jesus over to be crucified.

“So when Pilate saw that he was gaining nothing, but rather that a riot was beginning, he took water and washed his hands before the crowd, saying, ‘I am innocent of this man’s blood; see to it yourselves.’” Matthew 27:24 RSV

(Macbeth & Lay Macbeth washing hands of blood.)

“Come near to God and he will come near to you. Wash your hands, you sinners, and purify your hearts, you double-minded.” James 4:8 NIV

Having clean hands speaks of being morally clean.

Our body is the temple of the Holy Spirit.

“For by means of a harlot a man is reduced to a crust of bread; and an adulteress will prey upon his precious life. Can a man take fire to his bosom and his clothes not be burned? Can one walk on hot coals, and his feet not be seared? So is he who goes in to his neighbor’s wife; whoever touches her shall not be innocent.” Prov. 6:26-29

Having clean hands speaks of being clean from other sexual sins

“Do you not know that the unrighteous will not inherit the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived. Neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor homosexuals, nor sodomites, nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners will inherit the kingdom of God. And such were some of you. But you were washed, but you were sanctified, but you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus and by the Spirit of our God.” 1 Cor 6:9-11

Having clean hands speaks of being clean in telling the truth.

“Lord, who may abide in your tabernacle? Who may dwell in your holy hill? He who walks uprightly, and works righteousness, and speaks the truth in his heart.” Psalm 15:2

“Beloved, I pray that you may prosper in all things and be in health, just as your soul prospers. For I rejoiced greatly when brethren came and testified of the truth that is in you, just as you walk in the truth. I have no greater joy than to hear that my children walk in truth.” 3 John 1:2-4

Having clean hands refers to keeping clean verbally.

*“Set a guard, O Lord, over my mouth; keep watch over the door of my lips.”
Psalm 141:3*

“He who walks uprightly, and works righteousness, and speaks the truth in his heart; He who does not backbite with his tongue, nor does evil to his neighbor, nor does he take up a reproach against his friend; in whose eyes a vile person is despised, but he honors those who fear the Lord; he who swears to his own hurt and does not change; he who does not put out his money at usury, nor does he take a bribe against the innocent. He who does these things shall never be moved.” Psalm 15:2-5

How do we need to use our hands and why should they need to stay clean?

1. Lifting up holy hands

“Let my prayer be set before you as incense, the lifting up of my hands as the evening sacrifice.” Psa. 141:2

“I desire therefore that the men pray everywhere, lifting up holy hands, without wrath and doubting.” 1 Tim. 2:8

“Behold, bless the Lord, all you servants of the Lord, who by night stand in the house of the Lord! Lift up your hands in the sanctuary, and bless the Lord. The Lord who made heaven and earth bless you from Zion!

2. Lay hands of the sick

“And these signs will follow those who believe: In my name they will cast out demons; they will speak with new tongues; they will take up serpents; and if they drink anything deadly, it will by no means hurt them; they will lay hands on the sick, and they will recover.” Mark 16:17-18

“Now he could do no mighty work there, except that He laid His hands on a few sick people and healed them.” Mark 6:5

“And it happened that the father of Publius lay sick of a fever and dysentery. Paul went in to him and prayed, and he laid his hands on him and healed him.” Acts 28:8

3. Spiritual gifts were given by laying hands on certain people

“Do not neglect the gift that is in you, which was given to you by prophecy with the laying on of the hands of the eldership.” 1 Tim 4:14

“Therefore I remind you to stir up the gift of God which is in you through the laying on of my hands.” 2 Tim. 1:6

4. People will receive the baptism of the Holy Spirit by hands laid on them

“And when Simon saw that through the laying on of the apostles’ hands the Holy Spirit was given, he offered them money, saying, ‘Give me this power also, that anyone on whom I lay hands may receive the Holy Spirit.’ Acts 8:18-19

“Now when the apostles who were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent Peter and John to them, who, when they had come down, prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit. For as yet he had fallen upon none of them. They had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. Then they laid hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit.” Acts 8:14-17

5. To get strong in Jesus you must have clean hands

“Yet the righteous will hold to his way, and he who has cleans hands will be stronger and stronger.” Job 17:9

“And they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and the Holy Spirit, and Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolas, a proselyte from Antioch, whom they set before the apostles; and when they had prayed they laid hands on them.” Acts 6:5-6

6. Miracles happen through the use of anointed hands’

“Now God worked unusual miracles by the hands of Paul, so that even handkerchiefs or aprons were brought from his body to the sick, and the diseases left them and the evil spirits went out of them.” Acts 19:11-12

7. Signs and wonders through hands

“And through the hands of the apostles many signs and wonders were done among the people. And they were all with one accord in Solomon’s Porch.” Acts 5:12

8. Reaching out to the poor with your hands

“She extends her hand to the poor, yes; she reaches out her hands to the needy.” Prov. 31:20

The Bride of Christ is to make herself /her clothes clean and ready for heaven.

“Let us be glad and rejoice and give Him glory, for the marriage of the Lamb has come, and His wife has made herself ready. And to her it was granted to be arrayed in fine linen, clean and bright, for the fine linen is the righteous acts of the saints.

(Have ushers pass out the wet wipes.) Ask the pastors and leaders to come forward and wash hands in pan if you would want to do that. (Ask all who would like to get saved or rededicate their lives to Jesus to come forward.)

I appeal to you that we all cleanse our hands and hearts by repentance and asking for forgiveness. I will wash my hand in a pan of water and instruct the people to take a wet wipe and when we all have one, and then wash our hands. Ask all who would like to get saved or to rededicate their lives to Jesus come to and wash hands. Pray a prayer of dedication with the people all together.

Father, I have nothing to bring to you but uncleanness. You decreed from the foundation of the world that your Son, Jesus, would die. And you promised that by his blood I would be cleansed, and by his stripes I would be healed.

You also promised that I would be complete in Christ. You said you would keep me from falling, and that Jesus would be my intercessor. You promised that by faith in him, I would be fully accepted and adopted by you. You said, if we confess our sins, you are faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

Then you promised you would open your ears to my petitions. You promised to supply all my needs. And you told me to believe your prophets, who recorded in the Scriptures your promises to be merciful to me, always ready to forgive me.

You promised you wouldn't allow me to carry any load that I couldn't bear. And you told me, 'All things work together for good to them that love me and are called by me.'

Father, these are all your decrees. They are your very own promises. And you cannot deny your own words. You are the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob and you are also my God. Oh, Lord, have mercy and grace on me now, cleanse me in my hour of need. Father, by faith I am cleansed. Amen!